

CEMENTING GROWTH

Under K.C. Jhanwar, UltraTech Cement is making all the right moves to increase capacity, moving into newer markets with a sharp focus on sustainability

By **Krishna Gopalan**



EYES ON THE PRIZE K.C. Jhanwar, Managing Director, UltraTech Cement

110 | ► **ASK K.C. JHANWAR** what UltraTech Cement has been doing over the past three years and pat comes the reply: “Our philosophy is to work on a long-term vision and plan, which is value-accretive to all stakeholders.” The company’s Managing Director explains that this includes all spheres of the business from operational excellence to new product development, a high focus on green products and brand building. “None of this can be achieved without having high empowerment and agility across the organisation,” says Jhanwar, a chartered accountant by training.

Cement is an intensely competitive business and UltraTech is the largest player—it has an installed capacity of 140 million tonnes per annum (mtpa); the Adani Group, through various entities, is the second largest at around 75 mtpa. “We have been on a significant growth trajectory for several years and expect this growth phase to continue. Our Chairman (Kumar Mangalam Birla) has announced the ambition of achieving a capac-

ity of 200 mtpa and we want to convert that vision into reality,” says the MD of UltraTech Cement, which is a part of the Aditya Birla Group.

To get to a capacity of 200 mtpa, the company will need to focus on key areas like supply chain management and, as Jhanwar puts it, specifically on logistics operations and cost optimisation, and ensure improved response time for consumers. “We are also committed to further build on brand UltraTech and strengthen our equity across all our stakeholders,” says Jhanwar, a veteran of the Aditya Birla Group.

Excluding China, UltraTech today is the third-largest cement company in the world in terms of sales, and Jhanwar is hopeful that the company will move to the second position soon. In the commodity business, apart from just scale and size, building the brand is critical, he points out.

“That can be done by adopting the shift from product sales to becoming a solutions provider in the con-

► Building Capacity

❶ With an installed capacity of 140 mtpa, UltraTech is the largest cement player in India

❷ The company’s aim is to hit an installed capacity of 200 mtpa

❸ It has been involved in projects such as the new Parliament building and the Statue of Unity